

STARTER

Common Refusal Reasons & How to Avoid Them

Canada - Visitor Visa (Temporary Resident Visa)

TRV refusals are decided by an IRCC visa officer under IRPA/IRPR. There's usually no interview for most visitor applications - the officer decides on the written file, which makes complete, well-organised documentation especially important.

The most common specific reasons

1. Not satisfied you'll leave Canada by the end of your stay

The officer isn't convinced your circumstances support a genuine, temporary visit - the Canadian equivalent of a "ties to home country" concern.

- Evidence stable ties at home: employment, family, property, or ongoing study
- Be specific and consistent about your itinerary and purpose throughout the application
- Weak or thin travel history alone isn't automatically disqualifying, but pair it with strong current ties

2. Insufficient or unclear financial evidence

- Show funds proportionate to your stated trip length and plans, not just a single snapshot balance
- If someone else is funding your trip, include their evidence and a letter of invitation explaining the relationship and their commitment - see the Cover Letter and Sponsor Letter templates

3. Purpose of visit doesn't match the activities described

Selecting "tourism" while describing business activities (or vice versa), or describing activities that would actually require a work permit, undermines the officer's confidence in the rest of the application.

4. Incomplete or inconsistent travel/immigration history

- Disclose all previous visas, visits, and refusals - from Canada and any other country - honestly
- An undisclosed prior refusal is treated far more seriously than the refusal itself would have been

5. Missing or poorly organised supporting documents

Since most decisions are made on paper, a complete, clearly labelled document set matters more here than in visa categories with an interview. See the Document Checklist (Essential tier).

A REFUSAL ISN'T FINAL

There's no formal appeal for a refused TRV. Your realistic options are a fresh, stronger application, or - in narrow circumstances involving a procedural error - seeking leave for judicial review at the Federal Court. See the Refusal Decision Guide (Premium tier).